

Wyoming Data Centers Survey

Sources and Background for Voters

Why this survey was created

Wyoming is seeing increased public discussion about large data centers and other large-load facilities.

On June 3, 2026, Governor Mark Gordon issued Executive Order 2026-03, "Data Centers the Wyoming Way," creating a Wyoming Data Center Development Framework. Public reporting says the framework is intended to guide responsible development while protecting ratepayers, natural resources, local communities, water supplies, and Wyoming's way of life.

This survey was created to ask Wyoming voters what standards should apply before large data center projects move forward.

Short neutral background

Data centers are facilities that use computer servers to store, process, or move digital information. These facilities can support internet services, cloud computing, artificial intelligence, business data, and digital infrastructure.

Large data centers may bring investment, jobs, tax revenue, and technology-related development.

Large data centers may also affect water use, water quality, electric infrastructure, electric rates, land use, wildlife, housing, roads, public services, noise, and local planning.

This survey does not take a position for or against data centers. It asks what safeguards, benefits, and public-review standards Wyoming voters believe should apply.

Definitions

Data center: A facility with computer servers used to store, process, or move digital information.

Large-load facility: A project that requires a large amount of electricity.

Ratepayer protection: Policies or agreements intended to prevent existing homes and small businesses from paying added costs created mainly by a large new project.

Closed-loop cooling: A cooling system that reuses water instead of relying only on continuous new water use. Water may still require maintenance, treatment, or periodic replacement.

Community benefit: A direct local benefit connected to a project, such as infrastructure support, workforce training, local tax revenue, housing support, road improvements, school support, or public-service support.

Key issue areas for voter input

The survey focuses on practical standards that may be considered before a large data center is approved.

- Water use and water quality
- Electric rates and grid reliability
- Who should pay for project-related infrastructure
- Local public input
- State and local approval roles
- Jobs and workforce training
- Tax revenue and community benefits
- Wildlife, open space, agriculture, and land use
- Transparency before approval
- Long-term site reuse or cleanup

Public discussion reflected in sources

Public reporting and commentary identify both potential benefits and potential concerns. Benefits discussed include private investment, tax revenue, energy development, workforce opportunities, and digital infrastructure. Concerns discussed include water demand, electric-rate impacts, local infrastructure costs, environmental impacts, transparency, and the role of state and local decision-makers.

The source list below is provided so voters can review the public discussion for themselves. Reading these sources is optional and is not required to answer the survey.

Source list

Governor Mark Gordon — Executive Order 2026-03: Data Centers the Wyoming Way

<https://governor.wyo.gov/>

Cowboy State Daily — Gordon Orders Responsible Data Center Development In Wyoming — June 3, 2026

<https://cowboystatedaily.com/2026/06/03/gordon-orders-responsible-data-center-development-in-wyoming/>

WyoFile — Gov. Gordon demands data center developers do it the Wyoming way — June 3, 2026

<https://wyofile.com/gov-gordon-demands-data-center-developers-do-it-the-wyoming-way/>

Cowboy State Daily guest column — Governor Gordon: Managing Data Centers To Protect Wyoming Way While Securing Our Economic Future — June 5, 2026

<https://cowboystatedaily.com/2026/06/05/guest-column-managing-data-centers-to-protect-wyoming-way-while-securing-our-economic-future/>

Cowboy State Daily guest column — Sen. Cheri Steinmetz: Gordon Gets It Wrong Again By Trying To Fast-Track Data Centers — June 4, 2026

<https://cowboystatedaily.com/2026/06/04/guest-column-gordon-gets-it-wrong-again-by-trying-to-fast-track-data-centers/>

Sheridan Media — Governor Gordon Signs Executive Order Establishing Wyoming Data Center Development Framework

<https://sheridanmedia.com/news/233700/governor-gordon-signs-executive-order-establishing-the-wyoming-data-center-development-framework/>

Wyoming Legislature — bills, statutes, and interim committee materials

<https://wyoleg.gov/>

Wyoming Public Service Commission — utility proceedings and public notices

<https://psc.wyo.gov/>

Wyoming State Engineer's Office — water-rights information

<https://seo.wyo.gov/>

Local records to add when available

When a survey references a specific proposed project, the public source file should also include local records, such as:

- County commission agendas, packets, and minutes
- City council agendas, packets, and minutes
- Planning and zoning materials
- Industrial siting or permit records
- Water-service and utility-service agreements
- Public comments submitted to state or local agencies
- Project-specific maps, site plans, and impact summaries

Suggested use on the survey page

Keep the survey page short. Put privacy at the top, then link to this background file for voters who want more context. The survey questions should remain plain, direct, and easy to answer.

Take the survey: grassrootsmovement.org/surveys/wy-data-centers